

GEN 001 MIDTERM REVIEWER

LESSON 6: Writing a Cohesive Paragraph

Paragraph is a sequence of sentences all related to a single topic. Anything you write that is longer than a few sentences should be organized into paragraphs.

The length can vary. For this lesson and the next few lessons, we will be practicing with the 5-6 sentence paragraph that has 1 topic, 1 claim (main idea), 3 supporting evidences, and 1 conclusion.

Claim is a statement that asserts a specific idea, opinion, or argument that the writer intends to prove or support

Evidences are the facts, examples, statistics, quotes, or other data that support and validate the claim or main idea presented in the paragraph.

Cohesive paragraph is a sequence of sentences all related to a single topic which helps the reader to see how a long piece of writing is arranged.

LESSON 7 and 8: Avoiding Plagiarism

Plagiarism is when you present someone else's work as your own original work. This can happen when you copy and paste without naming the author or source.

Plagiarism is considered unethical due to the following reasons:

- Intellectual Theft
- Breaking Trust
- Reduced Honor
- Legal Consequences
- Academic Dishonesty

Paraphrasing is rewriting the writer's ideas in your own words and name the writer.

- a. keep the meaning
- b. change the words and the word order
- c. give reference details

Summarizing is rewrite the writer's ideas in your own words in a shorter form

- a. keep the author's main ideas
- b. avoid copying the author's words
- c. make it clear which ideas are yours, and which are the author's
- d. give reference details

Referencing is acknowledging the writer and show the reader where ideas came from.

Referencing can be in any two places.

- a. In-text: in the paragraphs of your essay/report

- b. Reference list: end of the essay/report

APA format (American Psychological Association)

Website: Last name, F.M. (**Year published**). Article title. Website. URL.

Book: Last name, F.M. (Year published). Title. Publisher

- c. If something is common knowledge – information that many people know that you don't need to reference it. Common knowledge usually includes major historical events, famous people, and geographic areas.

LESSON 10: Narrative Essay

A **narrative** is a story or an account of events, experiences, or interactions, often presented in a sequential manner.

The story elements are:

Setting – time and place the story happens; atmosphere and mood

Characters – the individuals in the story

Plot – the sequence of events or actions of the characters that tells the story. It has a clear beginning, middle, and end.

Conflict – the problem or the struggle between two opposing sides that needs to be solved;

Resolution – the way the problem is solved

Point of View – how the story is told – specifically, who tells the story

Theme – the big idea or general observations about human nature and life presented in the story.

A **literary device** is an element or technique that authors use to produce a particular effect in their writing. Below are some examples of literary devices.

Simile - compares two different things using the words "like" or "as"

Metaphor - A metaphor is a figure of speech that says one thing is another thing to show they are alike in a way, without using "like" or "as."

Personification - is when the writer gives inanimate objects or ideas human traits

Hyperbole - is an exaggeration of an action or idea for emphasis

Onomatopoeia - is where a word is written the same as it sounds when spoken aloud

LESSON 12: Opinion Essay

Facts are statements that can be proven to be true or false. They are based on evidence and can be verified by research or observation.

Examples are:

1. The Earth orbits around the Sun.
2. Water freezes at 0 degrees Celsius (32 degrees Fahrenheit).
3. The capital of France is Paris.

Opinions are statements that express someone's beliefs, feelings, or thoughts. They cannot be proven true or false because they are based on personal perspectives or preferences.

Examples are:

1. Chocolate ice cream is the best flavor.
2. Dogs are better pets than cats.
3. Summer is the most enjoyable season because of the warm weather and outdoor activities.

Opinion Essays express what you think or feel about an issue.

When writing an opinion essay, our **claim** or **main idea** would contain whether we are agreeing or disagreeing with an issue or proposing a solution to an issue. This is also what we will be using as our introduction. **Evidences** for our opinion essays which will be discussed in the body of an essay would be the reasons why we agree or disagree. Your **conclusion** could be a summary, final thought, or call to action.

LESSON 13: Persuasive Essay

A **persuasive or argumentative essay** is like a debate on paper. In this type of writing, you try to convince others that your opinion is the best by using logic and reason. You want them to agree with you or do something you suggest. A good persuasive essay not only explains why your idea is right but also why the other side is wrong.

Tips in Writing a Persuasive Essay

1. Pick a side or suggest a solution.
2. Understand who you're writing for and why.
3. Use logic and feelings to persuade.
4. Research your topic using trustworthy sources and take notes.
5. Consider both sides of the argument and explain why the other side is wrong.

Here are five common persuasive devices that you can use to win an argument.

Persuasive Device	Definition	Example
Pathos	using emotional language to make people feel for you	"If I have a curfew, I won't be able to go out with my friends and do everything they do."
Big Names	using the names of experts or well-known people who support your position	"Psychologists agree that giving teens more independence will ..."
Research and Logos	using studies, data, charts, illustrations, and logic	"This chart shows that the amount of time spent at ..."
Ethos	using language that shows that you are trustworthy and believable.	"In all my years as a student, I have always... "